



HS 343: Introduction Into Political Philosophy

Course Code	HS 343
Course Name	Introduction Into Political Philosophy
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the faculty member
Intended for	B.Tech
Distribution	Elective
Approval	2nd Adhoc Senate (May 2012)

Course Description

All political communities come into being not only for the sake of living, but for the sake of a way of living. Characteristic, then, of any political association is the attendant discourse on achieving the best and avoiding the worst for the community and its members. Political philosophy addresses itself to the concepts underlying political beliefs and practices, such that the clarification of concepts can yield a framework for the critical evaluation of these beliefs and practices.

Text and Reference Books

Required Reading

Select excerpts from
Plato: The Republic
Aristotle: Politics
Machiavelli: The Prince

Readings

1. D.D. Raphael, Problems of Political Philosophy, Macmillan, 2007.
2. Dorothy Pickles, Introduction to Politics, Methuen, 2008.
3. Leo Strauss, What is Political Philosophy?, Greenwood, 1973.

References

1. Ernst Cassirer, **The Myth of the State**, Yale U.P., 1946
2. Machiavelli, **The Prince**, trs. P. Bondanella & M. Musa, O.U.P., 1984.
3. Karl Marx, **On Historical Materialism, from: Marx and Engels**, Collected Works, New York International, 1976.
4. Michael Oakshott, **Rationalism in Politics**, LSE Inaugural Lecture, London 1962.
5. Henry David Thoreau, **On Civil Disobedience** (any edition).
6. Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, **Satyagraha**, ed. Anand Hingorani, Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan.
7. Eric Voegelin, **The New Science of Politics**, Chicago 1952